

LESSON TWENTY

TOPIC: THREE TESTS OF LOYALTY

TEXT: RUTH 1:14-17

MEMORY VERSE: Ruth 1:16

However, Ruth responded, "Do not urge me to leave you or to turn back from you. Wherever you go, I will go, and wherever you stay, I will stay. Your people will be my people, and your God will be my God."

CENTRAL TRUTH: God will undoubtedly reward our loyalty and faithfulness.

INTRODUCTION

Disloyalty frequently stems from immaturity. "And with Absalom went two hundred men out of Jerusalem, who were called; and they went in their simplicity, and they knew not anything" 2 Sam. 15:11. Loyalty today does not guarantee loyalty tomorrow. Cultivating trust through open communication, empathy, and shared values can assist in mitigating disloyalty.

LESSON OUTLINE

~ The Test of Distance: 2 Kings 5:20-22, 25-27

"But it is good to be zealously affected always in a good thing, and not only when I am present with you" Gal. 4:18

~ The Test of Time. John 18:25-27

"I marvel that you are so soon removed from him that called you into the grace of Christ unto another gospel"

Gal. 1:6.

~ The Test of Fire. Mal. 3:3. Daniel 3:16-18

God frequently applies pressure on his servants to elicit their best qualities. Often, He prefers to be in the fire with us rather than extinguish it.

CONCLUSION:

Loyal individuals quickly receive the anointing: "And it came to pass, when they had crossed over, that Elijah said to Elisha, 'Ask what I shall do for you before I am taken away from you.' And Elisha said, 'I pray thee, let a double portion of your spirit be upon me.' And he said, 'You have asked a difficult thing; nevertheless, if you see me when I am taken from you, it shall be so unto you; but if not, it shall not be so'" 2 Kings 2:9,10